

The Legend of Sachin

OCTOBER 5, 2009

India's greatest sporting icon and role model completes two record-breaking decades in cricket. An assessment of Sachin Tendulkar's place in history and his amazing career.



“No batsman in the history of cricket has displayed such consistency in both forms of the game. Sachin Tendulkar's combined Test and one-day international records may never be equalled.”

HARSH THAKOR, *Mumbai*

Glorious Ballgame

It is because of players like Sachin Tendulkar that cricket gained popularity in the country. People started watching the game as an alternative to cinema ("The Legend of Sachin", October 5). Tendulkar's unparalleled achievements in cricket would have fetched him a Noble Prize for entertainment, if there was any. We hope his twilight years would keep us entertained as much as his last two decades did.

SANJIV GUPTA,
Perth, Australia

As rightly pointed out in your cover story, Tendulkar's records are simply mindboggling. His great career has continuously been plagued with recurrent injuries which have been hampering his batting at the highest level



Class Apart

Shashi Tharoor's tweet stated that he would travel by "cattle class out of solidarity with all our holy cows" ("I will not stop tweeting", October 5). The reference to "cattle class" hurt the Congress that stands for the *aam aadmi* but what seems to have annoyed the party is the crack at "holy cows". In a nation of such political gravitas, Tharoor is unlikely to find many who will be willing to bell the holy cows or enjoy a good laugh.

MEGHANA M., *via www.indiatoday.in*

There lingers an enviable charisma around Tharoor which, of course, is alien to other politicians. Maybe this has compelled his counterparts to take a necessitated initiative to be critical of an otherwise jocular comment.

T.S. FERNANDO, *Chennai*

of competition. In the Champions Trophy for instance, Pakistan's pace bowler Mohammad Aamer openly boasted of a plan to dismiss Tendulkar and he succeeded in doing so. To ensure longevity to his illustrious cricketing career, it would be prudent if Tendulkar concentrates only on Test cricket and leaves the ODIs to the youngsters.

L.K. CHAWLA,
Gurgaon

Chanting Austerity

It is sad and unfortunate that the UPA Government has made a mockery of an otherwise serious issue ("The Austerity Charade, October 5)). Only few leaders in Indian politics have actually lived the phenomenon called austerity. Mahatma Gandhi, Sardar Patel, Jayaprakash

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